

In the Garden God Made

Unit 1 · Pillar 1: Design · Welcome — How This Curriculum Works

I am fearfully and wonderfully made; You wove me in the womb.

- Psalm 139:13-14

WEEK AT A GLANCE

- MONDAY** Welcome — meet your family of teachers + Story 1 begins.
Read Story 1 aloud.
- TUESDAY** How we discover an herb — every Tuesday, all year. Today: lavender.
- WEDNESDAY** How we use herbs — Wednesdays teach prep skills. Today: tea.
- THURSDAY** How herbs tell history + art — Thursdays, all year. Today: Lavender in monastery gardens — draw it.
- FRIDAY** Plant lavender. Sing the lavender chant for the first time.
Meet the Five Tenets today.

Subjects woven this week: Science · Health ·
Art · History · Language Arts · Movement

AROUND THE TABLE

*What helps your body feel calm —
and how do you know?*

KITCHEN LAB - SUPPLIES NEEDED

- Dried lavender buds (1 tsp)
- Raw honey
- Kettle
- Mug or cup
- Botanical sketchbook
- Journal & pen



Lavender

Lavandula angustifolia

Read-Aloud & Discussion

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Lavender

Foundations - Welcome Week

WELCOME ORIENTATION

Welcome to Eden's Table — Week 1 of your child's K-12 herbalism journey. This week is orientation: you'll meet your story family (Gracie, Vovó, Levi, Evie, PopPop, Bear) + learn how each day works — Monday Read-Aloud, Tuesday Discovery, Wednesday Kitchen Lab, Thursday History & Art, Friday Garden & Review. This week's herb is lavender — your first sensory anchor. Begin Story 1 today.

KEY CONCEPT

Your body was knit together by God (Psalm 139). This curriculum spends 12 years teaching what your body already knows.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Name something your body does without you telling it to.
2. Smell the dried lavender. What does it remind you of?
3. Who in your family knows the most about plants or cooking?

BEAR MOMENT

★ Meet Bear, the family dog. Every week a small box like this shares something Bear notices — usually what the children miss. Watch for him all year.

LAVENDER CHANT

*Lavender, gentle in the light,
Calms the morning, calms the night —
Spike of purple, breath of rest,
Of all the gentle herbs, the best.*

Today's threads: Language Arts • Health • Bible/Worldview

TEACHER NOTES

TEACHER NOTES:

★ MONDAY is read-aloud day. Each Monday for 36 weeks you read aloud — either a new story chapter (6 Mondays a year) or a scripture passage (30 Mondays a year). By Grade 2 your child has heard all 6 Eden's Table stories + 30 scripture readings every year — that's our family table built on Word and story together. Today: Story 1 begins. Read aloud to your child. Vovó's voice is warm, wise, deliberate — read her dialogue slowly. Don't rush to lavender's properties — those arrive Tuesday.

TODAY'S WORD:

SENSES — the five gifts (sight, smell, touch, taste, hearing) God gave your body.

Discovery

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Lavender

Foundations - Welcome Week

DISCOVERY LESSON

★ Tuesday is DISCOVERY day. Each Tuesday your child holds an herb, smells it, observes it. Today we discover lavender. Place dried lavender buds in your child's palm. Smell them together — what do they remind you of? Notice the tiny purple-blue buds and silvery leaves. Lavender is in the mint family — square stem, narrow opposite leaves, strong scent. God designed it small but mighty.

CORE QUESTION:

Why did God give us so many senses to know plants?

TEACHING PROGRESSION

★ Each Tuesday follows the same 4 steps:

1. Hold the herb. Notice its shape. Place dried lavender buds in your child's hand.
2. Crush a piece. Smell it. Look closely, and roll a bud between their fingers.
3. Define one new word: lavender is AROMATIC — its scent is part of how God designed it.
4. Together, look up where lavender grows around the world.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear sniffs deeply — lavender is AROMATIC, meaning we can smell its scent strongly. How many smells can you name in your kitchen?

LAVENDER CHANT

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TEACHER NOTES

TEACHER NOTES:

★ **TUESDAY** is wonder day. The format above (hold · crush · define · locate) repeats every Tuesday for 36 weeks. By Grade 2 your child has held + smelled 36 herbs and learned 36+ herbal words this way. Stay curious with them.

TODAY'S WORD:

AROMATIC — a plant whose scent is strong and lasting. Lavender is aromatic.

Kitchen Lab

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Lavender

Foundations - Welcome Week

KITCHEN LAB

★ Wednesday is KITCHEN LAB day. Each Wednesday your child learns a prep skill — across the year you'll meet 10 preparations together (tea, decoction, cold infusion, poultice, compress, sachet, syrup, honey-infusion, honegar, fresh-leaf). Today we brew lavender tea. Pour hot water over a small spoonful of dried lavender buds and watch the water turn pale gold-green. This is called an infusion — one of the oldest ways people have used plants. Notice the soft floral smell rising in the steam. Sip slowly and notice how your body and mind feel.

TEACHING NOTE

Hot water is hot. Children can measure the dry lavender and pour cool water. An adult always pours the boiling water. Cover the cup while steeping. Use food-grade culinary lavender only.

STEP-BY-STEP

★ Each Wednesday follows a 5-step prep: measure → prepare → time → finish → taste. Same five verbs every week; the herb + the prep change.

1. Measure 1 teaspoon dried lavender buds per cup.
2. Adult pours boiling water (8 oz) over the lavender.
3. Cover and steep 5 minutes.
4. Strain into a mug.
5. Add a touch of honey. Sip slowly and notice how it feels.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear watches the steam rise from the lavender INFUSION — that's the special word for tea made by steeping plants in hot water.

LAVENDER CHANT

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Today's threads: Science · Health · Language Arts · Math

TEACHER NOTES

TEACHER NOTES:

★ WEDNESDAY is hands-on day. The 5-step prep above repeats every Wednesday for 36 weeks; the herb + the prep change. Let your child measure, pour cool water, time the steep, taste. By Grade 2 they've made 36 preparations with their own hands. Hot water stays with you. Use food-grade culinary lavender only.

TODAY'S WORD: INFUSION — a tea made by steeping plants in hot water. Lavender tea is an infusion.

History & Art

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Lavender

Foundations - Welcome Week

HISTORY LESSON

★ Thursday is HISTORY & ART day. Each Thursday your child meets the people who knew this plant before us. Today we step back in time. Lavender is one of the oldest cultivated plants in history. Around 1100 AD, Benedictine monks grew lavender in monastery cloister gardens to use in their infirmaries, wash their cloths, and freshen the cool stone halls. Its name comes from the Latin lavare — to wash. Long before the monks, Romans put lavender in their bathwater. Even today, lavender grows wild across the hillsides of southern France — a fragrant purple gift God planted.

CREATION CARE TIMELINE

★ Every Thursday adds an entry to your child's Creation Care Timeline (post-launch poster — for now, start a paper timeline on the wall). This week: Around 1100 AD, Benedictine monks grew lavender in monastery gardens. They called it the washing-herb. Add medieval monks and lavender to your Creation Care Timeline poster — your first entry!

ART ACTIVITY

1. Look closely at a real lavender spike or a dried one.
2. Notice the tall green stem with tiny buds packed along the top.
3. Draw the spike shape — like a long narrow flame.
4. Add narrow silvery-green leaves below.
5. Color it: violet-purple for the buds, soft green-gray for the leaves.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear curls up like a monastery cat in the sun. The ancient MONASTERY was a quiet place where monks grew herbs and prayed — God's work in the garden.

LAVENDER CHANT

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Today's threads: History · Art · Language Arts

TEACHER NOTES

TEACHER NOTES:

★ THURSDAY is connection day. Each Thursday for 36 weeks your child meets the people who knew this herb before us + sketches it once. By Grade 2 they've added 36 entries to the Creation Care Timeline + filled 36 pages of their botanical sketchbook. Help your child see the long ribbon of people who have grown and loved plants — we're part of that ribbon now.

TODAY'S WORD: MONASTERY — a quiet place where monks lived, worked, and prayed; many monasteries grew herbs in their gardens to care for the sick.

Garden & Review

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Foundations - Welcome Week

GARDEN ACTIVITY

★ Friday is GARDEN & REVIEW day. Each Friday plant something + review the week. Today we plant lavender together. Find a sunny dry corner of your garden or a small pot of sandy soil. Lavender loves the sun and dislikes wet feet. Press a young lavender start gently into the soil, water lightly, and place it where it can soak up afternoon sun. While you wait for it to fill in, sing the lavender chant each morning when you water — and watch for the first purple spike to rise.

NEXT WEEK

Next week chamomile arrives — Vovó tends Gracie's cut, and we meet our first remedy. Story 1 continues.

WEEK REVIEW

1. Look at your lavender drawing above. Describe the plant in your own words.
2. What did God give us five senses for?
3. Who grew lavender in monastery gardens long ago?
4. Use the word AROMATIC in a sentence about lavender.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear digs a hole next to the new lavender. Good thing lavender is HARDY — it loves sun, dry soil, and isn't bothered by clumsy paws.

LAVENDER CHANT

*Lavender, gentle in the light,
Calms the morning, calms the night —
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Vovó says: Where lavender grows, sleep is not far behind.

Today's threads: Movement · Language Arts · Science

TEACHER NOTES

TEACHER NOTES:

★ *FRIDAY* is the gathering day. Each Friday for 36 weeks closes the week with a hands-on garden touch + a review of what you learned. Some Fridays you plant (about 18 a year — fall + spring); most Fridays you tend, dry, harvest, observe, or weed what's already growing. By Grade 2 you've tended a working herb garden together for three years — the same plants returning each spring.

TODAY'S WORD: HARDY — a plant strong enough to survive in dry soil and full sun.

FIVE TENETS introduced today (memorization arc all year): Hydrate · Eat · Move · Rest · Connect.